



A revolution is on the cards. Gone are the days when people would shy away from an inkjet printer because of the cost involved, and settle for an aging dot matrix printer instead. Due to the fierce competition between the major players in the printer market, costs have drastically fallen, making inkjet printers increasingly affordable for the masses. Where a year ago, an entry-level inkjet printer would cost around Rs 6,000 to Rs 7,000, today the same costs around Rs 3,000 to Rs 4,000.

But before you buy a printer, you need to chalk out your needs, budget and the frequency of your printing. A user who prints two-odd pages, once or twice a week, will find investing in a costly printer an overkill. An entry-level printer would meet his needs, and provide acceptable quality at a good price. The same entry-level printer will not meet the needs of a professional who demands quality printing at high speeds. Again, for gadget enthusiasts who indulge in convergence, printers now allow direct printing of photographs from a digital camera, skipping the intermediary PC.

The usage pattern for any printer shows text printouts at the top of the chart, followed by combination documents of text and images—Very rarely does one, other than a professional, use a printer solely for printing images. Any entry-level printer can satisfactorily print text-only documents. Higher-level printers provide

Prints